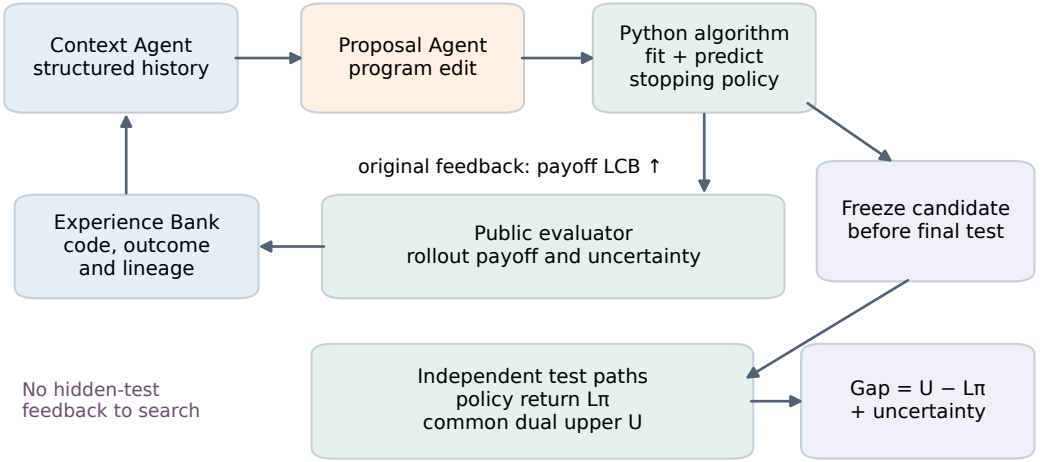A Search loop and independent gap evaluation